economic harm, it did not interfere with interests that were sufficiently bound up with the reasonable expectations of the claimant to constitute "property" for Fifth Amendment purposes. See, *e. g., United States* v. *Willow River Power Co.,* 324 U. S. 499 (1945) (interest in high-water level of river for runoff for tailwaters to maintain power head is not property); *United States* v. *Chandler-Dunbar Water Power Co.,* 229 U. S. 53 (1913) (no property interest can exist in navigable waters); see also *Demorest* v. *City Bank Co.,* 321 U. S. 36 (1944); *Muhlker* v. *Harlem R. Co.,* 197 U. S. 544 (1905); Sax, Takings and the Police Power, 74 Yale L. J. 36, 61–62 (1964).

More importantly for the present case, in instances in which a state tribunal reasonably concluded that "the health, safety, morals, or general welfare" would be promoted by prohibiting particular contemplated uses of land, this Court has upheld land-use regulations that destroyed or adversely affected recognized real property interests. See *Nectow* v. *Cambridge,* 277 U. S. 183, 188 (1928). Zoning laws are, of course, the classic example, see *Euclid* v. *Ambler Realty Co.,* 272 U. S. 365 (1926) (prohibition of industrial use); *Gorieb* v. *Fox,* 274 U. S. 603, 608 (1927) (requirement that portions of parcels be left unbuilt); *Welch* v. *Swasey,* 214 U. S. 91 (1909) (height restriction), which have been viewed as permissible governmental action even when prohibiting the most beneficial use of the property. See *Goldblatt* v. *Hempstead, supra,* at 592–593, and cases cited; see also *Eastlake* v. *Forest City Enterprises, Inc.,* 426 U. S. 668, 674 n. 8 (1976).

Zoning laws generally do not affect existing uses of real property, but "taking" challenges have also been held to be without merit in a wide variety of situations when the challenged governmental actions prohibited a beneficial use to which individual parcels had previously been devoted and thus caused substantial individualized harm. *Miller* v. *Schoene,* 276 U. S. 272 (1928), is illustrative. In that case, a state entomologist, acting pursuant to a state statute, ordered